

ExtremeTech, February 3, 2006

Why?

EVER REACH THE point of tearing your hair out when computing? Loyd Case at ExtremeTech vents some of his frustrations with software.

EXTREME TECH WORLD'S #1 SOURCE FOR PC, MAC & MOBILE
 NEWS, REVIEWS, TIPS & TRICKS, FORUMS, BLOGS, DOWNLOADS, GAMES, MUSIC, VIDEO, AND MORE.
 Home > News > Why? by Loyd Case

Why?
 Sometimes things puzzle me about the tech universe. I understand that technology evolves, and that different engineers and product designers may make different decisions. I may not agree with many of those decisions. But there are still some things that just bug me, and I can only ask: "Why?"

These questions are in no particular order of importance or priority. We have a lot of astute readers, so I throw these questions out to the world in general. If you've got an answer, drop by the forums and let me know.

Question: Why don't motherboard manufacturers attach motherboard socket back plates so they don't fall off when you remove the screws?

These days, I often use CPU coolers that are more exotic than the standard coolers that ship inside retail boxed CPU packages. Quite a few of them try to be universal, and work with any socketed CPU. I can certainly understand why they'd want that—why ship multiple SKUs of the same thing with just different socket adapters? I've run across a number of them for Socket 939 motherboards that ask you to screw something into the CPU socket back plate. This is a small plastic backing plate that mounts on the underside of the motherboard, and acts as a mount point for the heat sink retention module.

Often, when you remove the screws, the back plate falls off. This is a real nuisance if you're trying to work with a motherboard that's already screwed into the case. It means having to remove the motherboard, which entails taking out all the expansion cards.

But not all back plates are like this. Some remain attached. But if they do need to be removed, it's a simple thing to lever them off with a screwdriver. So why don't all motherboard makers attach the back plate in this fashion?

Q: Why do some antivirus programs and spyware applications steal focus when they start a scheduled scan?

Some of you who are gamers instantly know what I'm talking about. Every Friday night, we have a LAN party in my basement office. Often, my system is used as the game server. We'll fire up a game, and right in the middle of the action, everyone's game freezes. Why? Because an anti-virus scan has kicked off on my computer (the server).

Now, I've fixed the main problem by simply rescheduling the virus scan. But why does an anti-virus or spyware sweeper need to grab focus in the first place? If there ever was a task that could run in the background, a pre-scheduled anti-virus scan would be it.

Sometimes things puzzle me about the tech universe. I understand that technology evolves, and that different engineers and product designers may make different decisions. I may not agree with many of those decisions. But there are still some things that just bug me, and I can only ask: "Why?"

These questions are in no particular order of importance or priority. We have a lot of astute readers, so I throw these questions out to the world in general. If you've got an answer, drop by the forums and let me know.

Question: Why don't motherboard manufacturers attach motherboard socket back plates so they don't fall off when you remove the screws?

These days, I often use CPU coolers that are more exotic than the standard coolers that ship inside retail boxed CPU packages. Quite a few of them try to be universal, and work with any socketed CPU. I can certainly understand why they'd want that—why ship multiple SKUs of the same thing with just different socket adapters? I've run across a number of them for Socket 939 motherboards that ask you to screw something into the CPU socket back plate. This is a small plastic backing plate that mounts on the underside of the motherboard, and acts as a mount point for the heat sink retention module.

Often, when you remove the screws, the back plate falls off. This is a real nuisance if you're trying to work with a motherboard that's already screwed into the case. It means having to remove the motherboard, which entails taking out all the expansion cards.

But not all back plates are like this. Some remain attached. But if they do need to be removed, it's a simple thing to lever them off with a screwdriver. So why don't all motherboard makers attach the back plate in this fashion?

Q: Why do some antivirus programs and spyware applications steal focus when they start a scheduled scan?

Some of you who are gamers instantly know what I'm talking about. Every Friday night, we have a LAN party in my basement office. Often, my system is used as the game server. We'll fire up a game, and right in the middle of the action, everyone's game freezes. Why? Because an anti-virus scan has kicked off on my computer (the server).

Now, I've fixed the main problem by simply rescheduling the virus scan. But why does an anti-virus or spyware sweeper need to grab focus in the first place? If there ever was a task that could run in the background, a pre-scheduled anti-virus scan would be it.

For the complete column, visit <http://snipurl.com/digitmedia4> (www.extremetech.com/article2/0,1697,1920034,00.asp)



Professional quality printing even onto CDs. For professionals.



OK, let's be professional for a moment. The EPSON Stylus Photo 950 makes everything look sexy. With a miniscule 2pl Ultra-Micro Dot and 2880 x 1440 dpi it gives excellent print quality, whether you're giving your clients CDs, or yourself a bit of a face lift. And because of the VSDI (Variable Sized Droplet) technology for non-bleeds, you'll capture outstanding detail fast so you won't have to camp round.

EPSON. See what you're missing.

the printer all night waiting. In fact the automatic cutter and catcher mean your borderless prints will be stacked ready to go. The EPSON Stylus Photo 950, all in all it'll make you look pretty damn good. For more details call 0800 220 546 or visit www.epson.co.uk

EPSON

Interesting use for nose #8839

We usually have something to say about every ad, but this time, we were just too busy laughing!

At the heart of the image

Nikon

WELCOME TO THE WIRELESS WORLD

DISCOVER THE FREEDOM OF SENDING AND PRINTING PHOTOS, WITHOUT WIRES

No wires, no cables. Just sharp, vivid photographs transferred and printed wirelessly and effortlessly using built-in Wi-Fi technology. Nikon's fast performing, pioneering COOLPIX P1 and P2 also feature 3 advanced In-Camera technologies (first priority AI-D-Lighting and Red-Eye Fix) and an Aperture-priority Auto mode for increased control over lighting, depth of field, exposure and a world of creative freedom. Visit www.nikon.co.uk or call 0800 220 220.

Nikon wireless image transfer - More Fun, More Freedom

Wi-Fi

Bird on a wave?

"Wireless" is taken literally here: there aren't any wires between the poles. And that brought us to an intriguing question—in a wireless world, where would all the birds sit?